Robert Kotcher

YC alum, Carnegie Mellon alum, viral app founder, 2 exits

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Education

Carnegie Mellon University '12
BXA Computer Science, Arts

AlphaLab Accelerator '12
with Tunessence (acquired)

Projects

Cat-astrophe prevention unit ↗
I built a robot to spray my cat when he gets on the counter.

engineering

Research

Timing attacks using CSS filters ↗
51 citations

OAuth Demystified for Mobile Application developers ↗
180 citations

engineering

Recent professional experience

Founder, engineer @ inflightsimulator.com (August 2026 – present)

Inflight Simulator lets people explore the world as an airline passenger, choosing destinations and collecting country flags as they complete virtual flights.

Inflight Simulator went viral, reaching 60,000 flights within days of release.

Technical skills required included shadow mapping, geometry reduction, scene culling, frustum streaming, and character rigging.

engineering product growth

Founding engineer, team lead @ solosuit.com (2024 – present)

SoloSuit (Y Combinator, W21) helps Americans navigate debt lawsuits.

I contributed to SoloSuit's debt resolution platform, helping 200,000+ Americans navigate debt lawsuits and protecting $2.7 billion in claimed debt.

I increased the monthly settlement volume on SoloSettle by 20x over 20 months by leading dozens of A/B tests across the settlement funnel. I shipped a key experiment that increased sent settlement offers from 8% to 37%.

I lead a pod of 3–6 engineers, with team composition changing quarterly, and am responsible for the team's successful output.

I built and maintained core product features across a TypeScript, Ruby on Rails, and PostgreSQL stack, supporting a 12,000+ spec test suite.

engineering product growth

Product R&D @ Codecov (2020 – 2022)

Codecov was acquired by Sentry in 2022. I researched and built new products that were later handed off to the engineering team. My testing tool was one of the reasons for the acquisition.

engineering product

Senior Software Engineer @ SynthesisAI (2020 – 2023)

SynthesisAI was building a synthetic data generation platform. I maintained a server farm on AWS, orchestrated with Kubernetes, with an API built in Go.

engineering

Software Engineer @ expii.com (2015 – 2017)

I worked on Expii's interactive math and science learning platform, built with a React.js frontend and Flask backend.

engineering product

Software Engineer @ NASA (2013 – 2015)

I developed software for an ADS-B sense-and-avoid system that was licensed to Vigilant Aerospace.

engineering